Springfield Public Schools (MO) AI Handbook: Data and Student Privacy Passages

Excerpted verbatim from *AI Handbook (Springfield Public Schools, Missouri), Version 1.0, July 2026, accessible web version*. The source has no page numbers; locations are given by section. Ellipses (…) mark omitted text. This is the accessible web-page version of the handbook, which has no page numbers.

Strategic Plan Priorities (excerpt)

Source: web page, Strategic Plan Priorities

As responsible stewards of our resources, we are committed to bridging the digital divide and protecting data privacy and academic integrity.

Pillar 1: Ethical and Responsible Use (excerpt)

Source: web page, SPS AI Literacy Framework

For Students:

Protect your privacy—never type your full name, password, address, or your friends' information into an AI tool.

For Teachers & Staff:

Protect student data. Only use school-approved AI platforms that follow student privacy laws.

For Parents:

Talk with your child about digital safety at home. Remind them that whatever they type into a public AI tool can be stored, so they must keep personal information private.

District AI Guiding Principles: 3. Safe and Secure Use

Source: web page, District AI Guiding Principles

AI use must align with federal, state, and district regulations that protect staff and student data. This includes following district procedures for the use and adoption of AI tools along with compliance to federal laws such as the Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act (FERPA).

General Guidelines: Keep Private Information Private; Use Only District-Approved Tools

Source: web page, General Guidelines

Keep Private Information Private

Never enter personally identifiable information (PII) into AI tools not approved by SPS or into personal AI tools.

Use Only District-Approved Tools

District-approved tools have been vetted to ensure data privacy requirements are met. This ensures your information is not used to train AI models and that data is not shared publicly.

Embedded AI Instructional Resource Approval Process (excerpt)

Source: web page, Approved Tools / Approval Process

Such features must be used only as part of approved district resources and in accordance with district expectations for student privacy, academic integrity, and educator oversight.

Approval Workflow: Data Collection

No data is collected and/or shared:

May use with building Administrator approval.

Data is collected and/or shared:

Data Compliance:

Technology Department (Data Agreements-Contracts)

Data Privacy and Security Standards

Source: web page, Data Privacy and Security Standards

The use of all AI tools are treated in the same way as all other software applications. All staff and students are required to use technology in support of the education experience which includes using AI in a safe manner that protects all stakeholders.

This looks like never sharing personal details of students, staff, or other confidential information with AI tools. This includes, but is not limited to: full names, addresses, phone numbers, ID numbers, educational records, personnel records, health information, or financial information. When using approved AI tools, it is still preferred to anonymize information to avoid the potential sharing of PII.

Only using approved AI tools is one of the many ways you can safeguard this information. Using publicly available AI tools or personal accounts with AI tools can release this information and make it accessible to those that should not have access.

Take these steps in your use of AI tools to ensure you are being safe and responsible.

- Only use approved AI tools.
- Never provide confidential, sensitive, or personally identifiable information when using AI tools.
- Never use copyrighted materials (such as District curriculum) with AI tools without express permission by the owner to do so.

Guidelines for Educators: Protect Data and Privacy

Source: web page, Guidelines for Educators

- Teach students how to protect their privacy when using AI tools.
- Ensure students understand never to share personally identifiable information (PII) with AI and what PII might mean for them.

Guidelines for Students: Be a Good Digital Citizen (excerpt)

Source: web page, Guidelines for Students

- Do not share personal information with AI tools such as your name, address, phone number, or ID number.

How Students Might Misuse AI (excerpt)

Source: web page, Guidelines for Students

Create a fake image or recording of someone without their permission.

Consequences For Student Misuse (excerpt)

Source: web page, Consequences For Student Misuse

Using a non-approved AI tool during school hours or violating basic electronic device rules.

Using AI to create harmful, bullying, or sexual content, or attempting to hack/bypass district filters.

Student Misuse Guidelines for Staff and Administrators

Privacy Violations: Any student or staff member who enters Personally Identifiable Information (PII) into an unapproved AI tool will be subject to an administrative investigation and may face disciplinary action for violating data privacy laws.

How Staff Might Misuse AI: Violating Data Privacy

Source: web page, Guidelines for Staff

- Enter personally identifiable information (PII) such as a student's name and educational record into a public AI tool that is not approved by the district.
- Share security related information with an unapproved AI tool such as a school's emergency management plan.

Consequences for Staff Misuse (excerpt)

Source: web page, Consequences for Staff Misuse

Staff members who violate AI use prohibitions or data privacy standards are subject to discipline according to Board Policy GBCB (Staff Conduct) and Policy EHBC (Data Governance and Security) or other board policies as applicable.

- **Administrative Leave or Suspension**: In cases where an investigation is needed—such as a suspected data breach or harassment—a staff member may be placed on administrative leave (with Human Resources approval) while the district reviews the situation.
- **Termination of Employment**: Serious violations, such as entering Personally Identifiable Information (PII) into unvetted tools, creating altered media to harass others, or using AI for significant academic/professional dishonesty, are grounds for dismissal.

Key Compliance Standards

- **Privacy Violations**: Any employee who improperly handles student or staff data will be subject to an administrative investigation and may face disciplinary action for violating state and federal data privacy laws.

- **Mandatory Reporting**: If AI misuse involves illegal acts, such as the creation of harmful images or the theft of district data, the district will contact law enforcement or other legal authorities to report the activity.

Scenario: Writing a Letter of Recommendation (excerpt)

Source: web page, Guidelines for Staff

To polish the tone, they use an approved district tool but refer to the student only as "the student" or "Candidate A," ensuring they never enter Personally Identifiable Information (PII) like the student's full name or ID number into the prompt.

This ensures the final product is of high quality while strictly adhering to Board Policy EHBC and FERPA regarding data governance and student privacy.

Guidelines for Community: Protect Student Privacy and Safety

Source: web page, Guidelines for Community

Protecting the well-being of each student is our top priority, and that includes keeping their private data safe.

- **Keep PII Private**: Never enter a student's Personally Identifiable Information (PII)—such as full names, ID numbers, home addresses, or grades—into public AI tools like ChatGPT.
- **Use District-Approved Tools**: Encourage your child to use only the AI applications that have been officially vetted and approved by the district to ensure they meet strict safety laws like FERPA.
- **Monitor Age Rules**: Be aware that many AI tools have strict age limits (often 13 or 18). Always follow the district's rules regarding parental consent for these technologies.

Guidelines for Community: Open Communication (excerpt)

Source: web page, Guidelines for Community

- **Respect Options**: We respect family preferences. If you prefer that your child does not use independent AI tools, SPS will provide alternative assignments that meet the same learning goals.

Implementation: AI Safety Course and Age-Appropriate Access (excerpt)

Source: web page, Implementation

AI Safety Course

All staff members are required to complete a baseline safety course that covers how to protect student privacy and avoid entering Personally Identifiable Information (PII) into AI tools.

Age-Appropriate Access

Students under 14 will only see AI through teacher-led demonstrations and embedded into curriculum and assessment platforms. Students 14 and older may use approved tools independently if they have a specific teacher's permission.

Community and Family Engagement

Transparency: Schools will clearly communicate which AI tools are being used.

FAQ (excerpt)

Source: web page, Appendix, FAQ

Is my personal information safe when using AI?

Protecting your privacy is a top priority, and we only use tools that comply with strict laws like FERPA. Users should never enter "Personally Identifiable Information," like full names or student ID numbers, into public AI tools.

Which AI tools are allowed at SPS?

To ensure safety, stakeholders should only use AI applications that have been officially vetted and approved by the district. We maintain a "Vetted Tools List" to help students and staff know which tools meet our high standards for data privacy.

Are AI-enabled wearables, like smart glasses, allowed in class?

Currently, AI-enabled wearables such as smart glasses or pins are not permitted on campus.

Glossary (excerpt)

Source: web page, Appendix, Glossary

- **Data Privacy:** The practice of protecting personal information from being collected or used by AI companies without permission.
- **Personally Identifiable Information (PII):** Private details that can identify a specific person, such as full names, student ID numbers, home addresses, or grades.

Important Reminders for Citations (excerpt)

Source: web page, Appendix, Disclosure of AI Involvement

To stay accountable, you should be ready to show your AI chat history to your teacher if they ask to see how you developed your ideas.